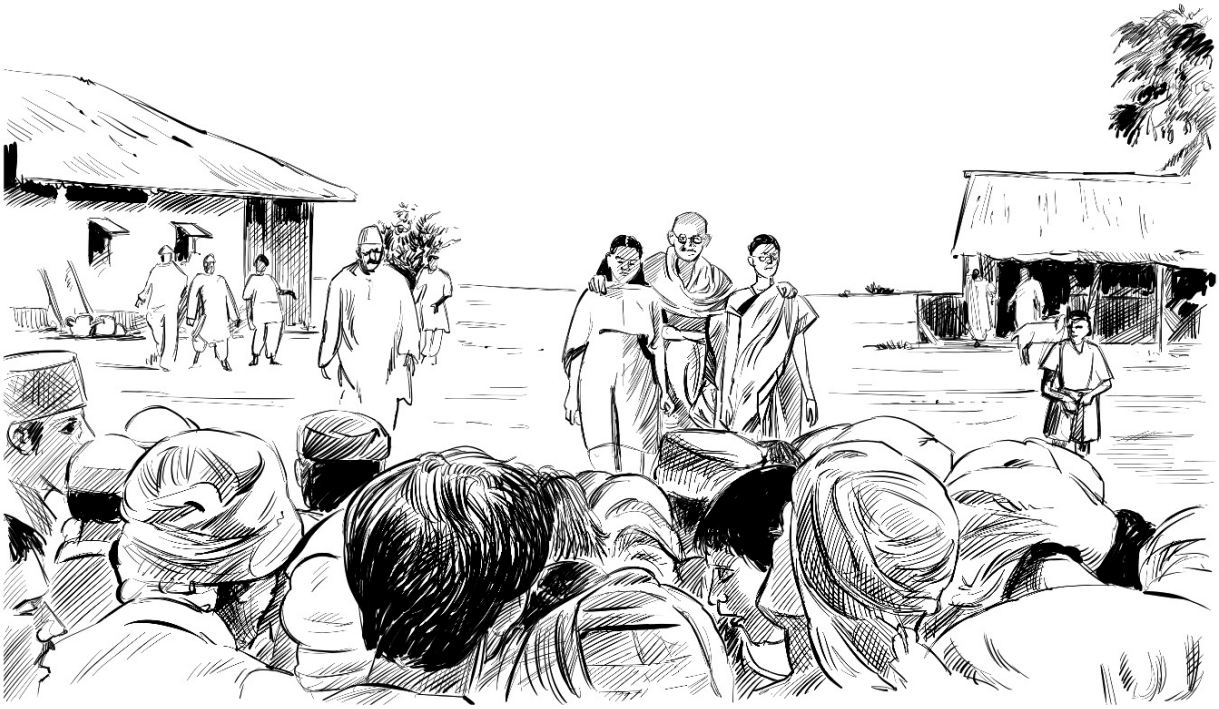


Most Indians looked up to Gandhi as a spiritual and political leader. But there was an extreme Hindu group that blamed Gandhi for the death of so many Hindus. They were upset that Gandhi had reached out to the Muslims.

As Gandhi headed toward the platform, Nathuram Godse, a Hindu extremist, pushed through the crowd to get close to him. He bowed before Gandhi. Then he took out a pistol. He fired three shots right into Gandhi's chest. Gandhi fell to the ground.

The evening Gandhi died, Prime Minister Nehru said in a radio address, "The light has gone out of our lives and there is darkness everywhere."

The people of India, and people everywhere, mourned the loss of one of the world's greatest teachers. Gandhi had been a light to the people of India and to the world. His light continued to shine as India grew as an independent nation. He proved that truth and love are the strongest forces for change.